WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

HAITI

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Cap-Haïtien and the North	Second city with an international airport open to US carriers and a working port; the most accessible base for current engagement	Port logistics, tourism, agro-processing, services
Caracol Industrial Park (North-East)	IDB-backed export park with its own roads, water and power, which had generated more than 15,000 jobs by 2020, 60% held by women	Apparel and light manufacturing for the US market
CODEVI free zone, Ouanaminthe (Dominican border)	Cross-border free zone beside Dajabón, with IDB Invest support for tenant firms' competitiveness and sustainable investment	Apparel, cross-border logistics
Port-au-Prince metropolitan area	Capital and main commercial centre, but armed groups control nearly 90% of the city and US flights to its airport are suspended until March 2027	Banking, administration, port services (when conditions allow)
Lafito port and industrial free zone (north of the capital)	Privately developed Panamax port with an adjoining free zone; operations depend on security along the coastal corridor	Container logistics, export manufacturing
Les Cayes and the South	Southern hub whose airport rehabilitation is in the IDB pipeline, opening a second gateway outside the capital	Agriculture, tourism, fisheries
Artibonite Valley	Haiti's main rice-growing area and agricultural heartland, currently affected by gang activity	Agriculture, irrigation, food processing

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Centre de Facilitation des Investissements (CFI), the national investment promotion agency, which has supported almost 50 companies since 2017 leading to 37 new investments and 42 reinvestments
- Investment Code granting foreign and domestic companies the same rights and equal legal protection
- Free-zone regime (Caracol, CODEVI, Lafito) combined with US duty-free access for apparel under HOPE/HELP, extended to 31 December 2026, and the CBTPA, authorised to 30 September 2030
- Banque de la République d'Haïti (BRH) oversight of a liberal foreign-exchange regime; the gourde held broadly stable at about 130 to the dollar through FY2025

- Co-investment alongside IDB Invest, which uses blended finance, advisory services and de-risking, including for PPP and performance-based infrastructure contracts
- Distributed energy and renewables, with the regulator ANARSE reviewing legislation to open the sector to private investment
- Mandatory sanctions screening: counterparties and supply chains must be checked against the UN 2653 sanctions list and US Foreign Terrorist Organization designations before entry

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Haiti in October 2026 is a market defined by its potential and by a stabilisation effort that is now firmly international. Macroeconomic management has been notably disciplined: Haiti met all IMF Staff-Monitored Programme targets at end-December 2025, the programme has been extended to June 2027, public debt is low at 11.7% of GDP, and gross reserves are projected at about $3.4 billion by end-FY2026, more than seven months of imports. Inflation has eased from a peak of about 32% to 17.5% in July 2026, and the gourde has held broadly stable. The economy has contracted for seven consecutive years, but the pace is moderating, from 4.2% in 2024 and 2.7% in 2025 to an expected 1.5–1.7% in FY2026, with the IMF projecting a return to growth of 0.5% in 2027. Diaspora remittances of about $3.8 billion in the first ten months of FY2025 underpin household demand, while foreign direct investment remains very small at around 0.1% of GDP, leaving significant room for first movers.

Haiti's main structural challenge is security. Armed groups control nearly 90% of Port-au-Prince, around 1.5 million people are displaced, and the UN renewed its sanctions regime, an asset freeze, travel ban and arms embargo covering nine individuals and the Viv Ansanm and Gran Grif gang coalitions, for a further 13 months in October 2026; the US has also designated both coalitions as Foreign Terrorist Organizations. The international response is gathering pace: the UN-authorised Gang Suppression Force of up to 5,500 personnel replaced the Kenyan-led mission in April 2026, had about 1,500 personnel deployed by late September, and has a mandate running to 31 March 2027, supported by a UN Support Office. Elections planned for 13 December 2026 were postponed in October pending a revised calendar. Activity in the North, which remains open to international flights and hosts the export free zones, offers a practical base, and investors who prepare now will be well placed as security is restored.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Security situation	Armed groups control nearly 90% of Port-au-Prince and parts of Artibonite, and around 1.5 million people are displaced; the Gang Suppression Force was at about 30% of planned strength in late September 2026	Base operations in the North, use professional security advisers and phase capital commitments to GSF deployment milestones
UN sanctions and US terrorism designations	The UN regime (asset freeze, travel ban, arms embargo) covers nine individuals and two gang coalitions, renewed in October 2026; the US lists Viv Ansanm and Gran Grif as Foreign Terrorist Organizations, so any payment to them risks material-support liability	Take sanctions counsel, screen partners, landlords and logistics providers, and adopt a firm no-payments policy for checkpoints and extortion
Political transition	Haiti has had no elected president since 2021 and the December 2026 elections were postponed in October pending a new calendar	Engage technocratic counterparts (BRH, Ministry of Economy and Finance, CFI), whose IMF programme commitments run to June 2027
US trade-preference timing	HOPE/HELP apparel preferences, extended retroactively in February 2026, run only to 31 December 2026	The CBTPA continues to 2030; build both scenarios into sourcing contracts and track renewal efforts in Congress
Economic contraction and inflation	Output has fallen for seven years and inflation was 17.5% in July 2026, though both trends are easing	Favour dollar-earning export models; low public debt and strong reserve cover support currency stability

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Power and infrastructure gaps	Only about half the population has electricity access, so most firms self-generate	Plan for captive solar and storage, an area where IDB Invest has already financed industrial projects
Administrative procedures and property title	Starting a business has taken about 97 days and registering property about 319 days	Use the CFI's facilitation service, experienced local counsel and thorough title due diligence

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Haiti's risk profile is dominated by security and its legal consequences, and investors should treat both as threshold questions. Armed groups control most of the capital, the UN sanctions regime against gang leaders and coalitions was renewed in October 2026, and the US Foreign Terrorist Organization designations of Viv Ansanm and Gran Grif mean that any direct or indirect payment to these groups, including at checkpoints, may create criminal and sanctions exposure; specialist sanctions counsel and rigorous screening of partners and supply chains are essential. Against this, the direction of travel is constructive: the Gang Suppression Force has an expanded mandate to March 2027 and is building towards 5,500 personnel, macroeconomic policy has met IMF targets, debt is low and reserves are strong. The North offers a workable operating base today, with international flights, free zones and duty-free access to the US market. A phased approach, starting with lawful export-oriented activity outside the capital and scaling as security milestones are met, allows investors to build position while managing exposure.

MARKET ACCESS

Haiti is a member of CARICOM and the WTO, but its most valuable access is to the United States, which takes the large majority of its exports: textiles and apparel account for about 77% of goods exports and nearly 90% of US-bound shipments. Haitian apparel enters the US duty-free under the HOPE/HELP programmes, extended in February 2026 to 31 December 2026, and the Caribbean Basin Trade Partnership Act, authorised to September 2030. The land border with the Dominican Republic, anchored by the CODEVI free zone at Ouanaminthe–Dajabón, provides a working cross-border supply corridor, and the northern ports and Cap-Haïtien airport give access to US East Coast markets that is less exposed to disruption in the capital. A large diaspora in the United States, Canada and France adds an established channel for consumer demand, trade links and investment.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the Prime Minister (Alix Didier Fils-Aimé)	Leads the transition government and its security, electoral and economic agenda	Primary reference point for national priorities and government engagement
Centre de Facilitation des Investissements (CFI)	National investment promotion agency and one-stop facilitator for new and existing investors	Standard first point of contact for market entry and incentives
Banque de la République d'Haïti (BRH)	Central bank; manages the gourde, reserves and banking supervision, including digital payments and AML/CFT reform	Relevant for currency, banking and compliance matters
Ministry of Economy and Finance	Leads the budget and the IMF Staff-Monitored Programme, extended to June 2027	Key counterpart for fiscal incentives and reform commitments
Gang Suppression Force and UN Support Office for Haiti	UN-authorised force of up to 5,500 personnel, with a mandate to 31 March 2027, working alongside the Haitian National Police	Track deployment milestones to time entry and expansion
ANARSE (energy sector regulator)	Regulates electricity and is reviewing legislation to enable private renewable investment	Counterpart for energy and mini-grid projects

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
UN Security Council 2653 Sanctions Committee	Maintains the list of sanctioned individuals and gang coalitions, renewed in October 2026	Essential reference for partner and supply-chain screening

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Association des Industries d'Haïti (ADIH) represents the apparel and manufacturing sector and works closely with US industry bodies such as the American Apparel and Footwear Association on trade-preference issues, while the Haitian-American Chamber of Commerce (AmCham Haiti) and the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of Haiti provide wider business networks. The Inter-American Development Bank and IDB Invest are the most active development partners for the private sector, offering blended finance, advisory support and infrastructure investment, particularly in the North, alongside the World Bank and the IMF's ongoing programme engagement. Free-zone operators at Caracol and CODEVI are a valuable source of practical intelligence on operating conditions, and the Haitian diaspora's professional and business networks in the United States, Canada and France offer trusted local connections.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Haiti currently suits investors with experience of complex markets and a long horizon: nearshoring apparel and light-manufacturing firms using the northern free zones and US duty-free access; impact investors and development-finance co-investors in renewable energy, mini-grids and agriculture; diaspora investors with established local networks; and logistics and services firms positioning in Cap-Haïtien and the North. All investors will need robust sanctions compliance and security planning, and those with an eye on reconstruction, infrastructure and tourism can use the current period to build relationships and readiness ahead of improved security.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Take sanctions and security advice before any commitment
Engage counsel on the UN 2653 regime and US terrorism designations, and a security adviser, to define lawful, safe operating parameters and a no-payments policy.

STEP 2: Engage the CFI and the free-zone operators
Use the investment agency's facilitation service and speak directly with Caracol and CODEVI operators about sites, incentives and current conditions.

STEP 3: Anchor initial activity in the North
Base operations around Cap-Haïtien and the northern free zones, which have international flights and port access outside the capital.

STEP 4: Partner with development finance
Explore co-investment, blended finance and risk-sharing with IDB Invest and other development partners, particularly in energy and agriculture.

STEP 5: Tie expansion to security and policy milestones
Track Gang Suppression Force deployment, the revised election calendar and HOPE/HELP renewal, scaling investment as conditions improve.